

Scratch — Events

(When Key Pressed)



What Are Events?

An event is something that happens.

In real life:

- A doorbell rings — you open the door
- An alarm goes off — you wake up



In Scratch, events tell the computer:

"When THIS happens, do THAT!"

Scratch Events Blocks

Events blocks are found in the Events category (yellow/orange tab).

Some important ones:

- When green flag clicked
- When this sprite clicked
- When [space] key pressed

Today we focus on:

"When [] key pressed"



The "When Key Pressed" Block

This block starts your code when you press a key on the keyboard.

It looks like this:

When [space] key pressed

You can change "space" to any letter or arrow key!



Which Keys Can We Use?

You can pick from many keys:

- Letters: a, b, c ... z
- Arrow keys: up, down, left, right
- Space bar
- Number keys: 0–9



Each key can do something different!

Let's Try It! — Move Right

Step 1: Open Scratch

Step 2: Choose a sprite (like the cat)

Step 3: Drag this code:

When [right arrow] key pressed
move 10 steps

Step 4: Press the right arrow key!

Watch your sprite walk right!



Let's Try It! — Move Left

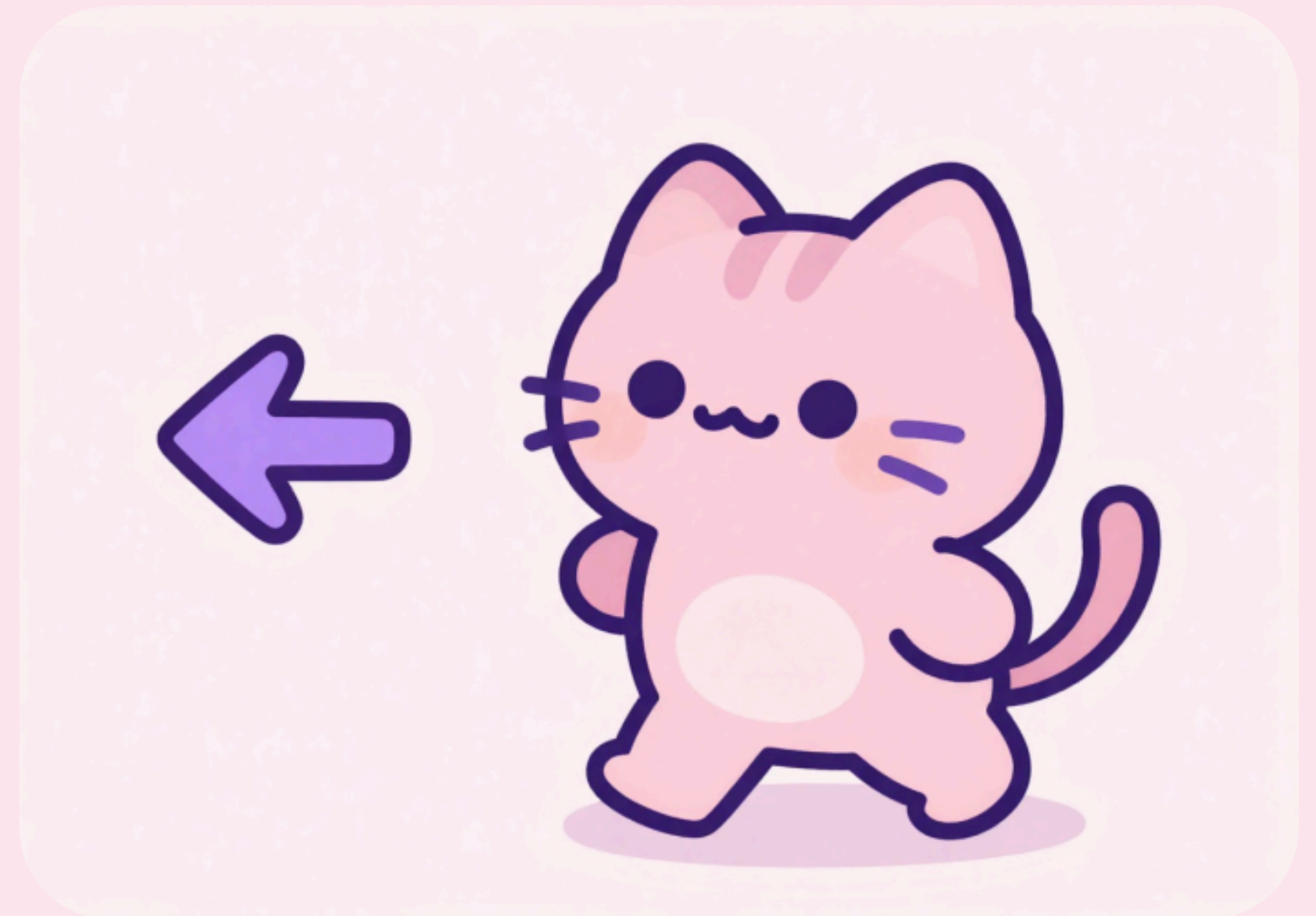
Now let's move LEFT!

Drag this code:

When [left arrow] key pressed
move -10 steps

The minus sign means
go backwards (to the left)!

Try pressing left arrow now!



Move Up and Down

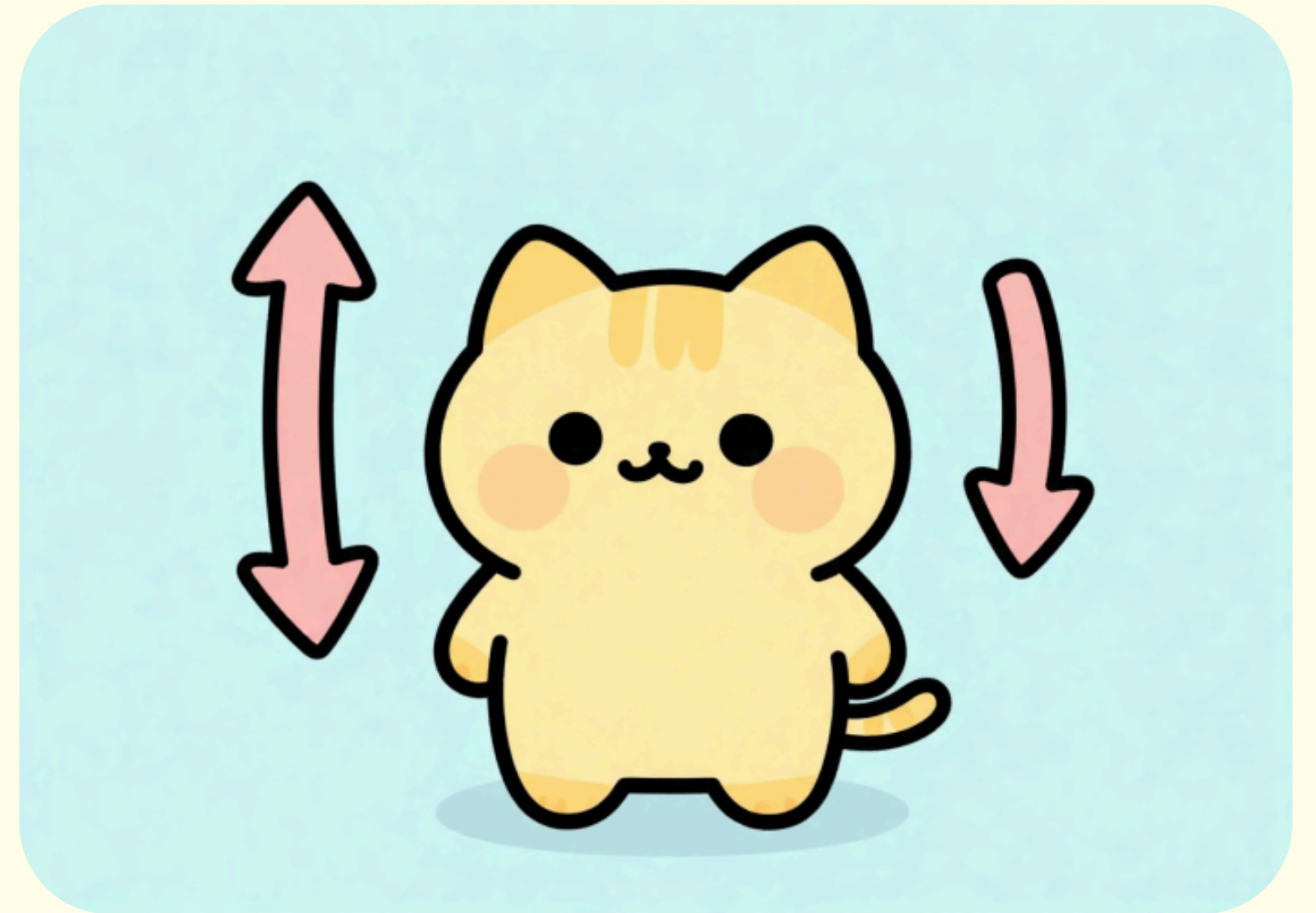
To move UP:

When [up arrow] key pressed
change y by 10

To move DOWN:

When [down arrow] key pressed
change y by -10

"y" means up and down direction!



All 4 Directions!

Now your sprite can move everywhere!

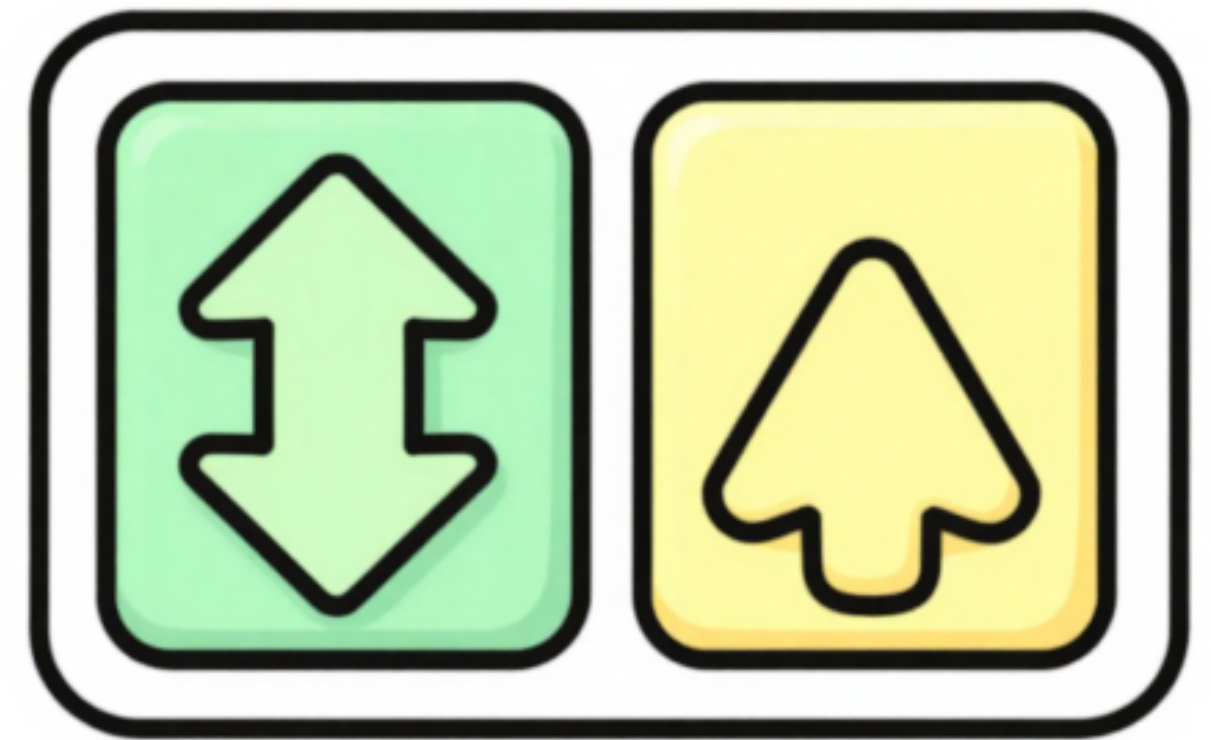
Right arrow → move 10 steps

Left arrow → move -10 steps

Up arrow → change y by 10

Down arrow → change y by -10

You just made a character
you can control with the keyboard!



Make It Say Something!

Keys can do more than move!

Try this:

When [s] key pressed
say "Hello!" for 2 seconds

Now press the S key —
your sprite talks!

You can change the message
to anything you like.



Change Costume with a Key

Want your sprite to change looks?

Try this:

When [c] key pressed
next costume

Every time you press C,
your sprite changes its costume!

This is great for animation.



Play a Sound with a Key

Keys can play sounds too!

Try this:

When [m] key pressed
play sound [Meow] until done

Press M and hear your sprite!

You can pick any sound
from the Sound Library.



Arrow keys → move around

S key → say hello

C key → change costume

M key → play a sound

They all work together!



Mini Project: Keyboard Pet!

Let's make a keyboard pet!

1. Pick a cute animal sprite
2. Arrow keys → move it around
3. Press S → it says "Feed me!"
4. Press C → it changes costume
5. Press M → it makes a sound

Your pet listens to YOUR keys!



What Did We Learn?

Today we learned:

- ✓ Events tell Scratch WHEN to act
- ✓ "When key pressed" listens for keyboard keys
- ✓ We can move, talk, change costume, and play sounds
- ✓ Many keys can work together

You are now a Scratch Events pro!



Thank You! 🎉

Great job today, coders!

Keep exploring Scratch at home.
Try adding MORE keys
and MORE actions!

What will YOUR sprite do next?

Happy Coding! 💻🎮

